

ART EXHIBITION

Crafty Business

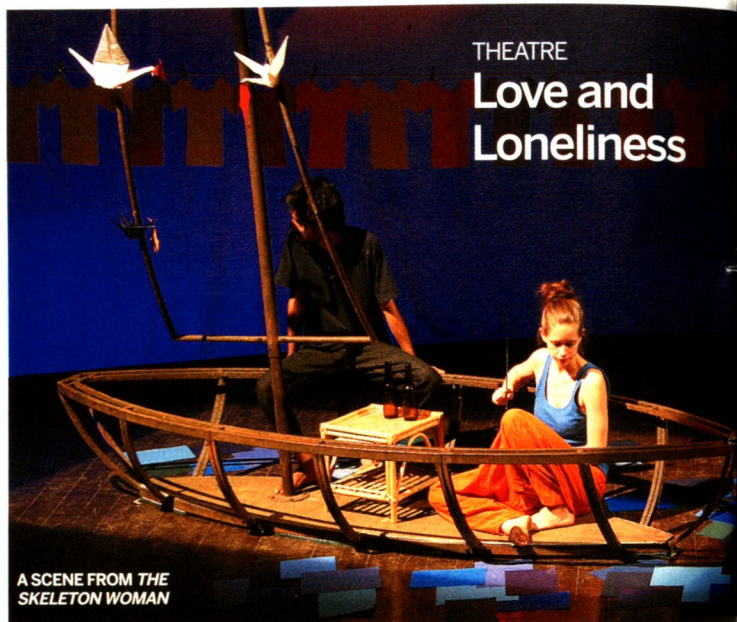
For those looking to invest in affordable art and contribute to a good cause, here's your chance to do both at one go. The Cancer Patients Aid Association (CPAA), as part of its annual fundraising project, is back with its trademark 'Colours of Life' exhibition. This year, over 100 artists will participate, making the collection bigger and better. Artists like Akbar Padamsee, Buwa Shete, Jogen Chowdhury, Vrindavan Solanki, Prafulla Dahanukar, Hema Joshi, Samir Mondal and Ajay De will be among those on display. The theme for this year's show is 'Affordable Art for Affordable Drugs' and is curated by Piali Syam of CPAA. "The exhibition allows art lovers to take home a work of art and make



(CLOCKWISE) WORKS BY ROHAN SONAVANE, YUSUF C.R., SUMITA ACHARYA AND BRINDA C. MILLER

a difference to the lives of children suffering from this terrible disease," says Syam. The exhibition will be on at the Cymroza art gallery from June 22 to 30 in Mumbai.

by Swati Mathur



THEATRE

Love and Loneliness

A SCENE FROM THE SKELETON WOMAN

Mountain MAN

Whenever the corporate drill would stop stimulating him, Gaurav Punj, 29, would take off to the Himalayas. Soon he realised that others wanted to pick up their bags and travel too. This engineer from the University of California, Berkeley, started organising Himalayan sojourns part-time. But it didn't take much time for Punj to trade his desk job with his backpack to start Connect With Himalayas (CWH).

What Punj organises trips once a month to places in Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Garhwal, Kumaon and Sikkim.

How CWH works with the locals to conduct trips in conjunction with NGOs and groups. Home stays, skiing, yoga trips, jungle safaris,

exploratory treks and camping holidays are some of the options.

What's Special At the end of every Himalayan sojourn, CWH makes a contribution to the place and its locals as it is their help they seek. During a trip to Darjeeling, they donated pressure cookers to reduce cooking time.

Why While travelling to the Himalayas, Punj was saddled with tour guides. The only way he could do his own thing was by spending a large sum on exclusively planned trips. So he planned everything himself. He knew if he wanted to travel to these unknown wonders, others would too. According to him, these places are the ones really worth seeing.

by Jhilmil Motihar

IF YOU THINK playing the guitar is a male prerogative think again. Hindustani classical musician Kamala Shankar has reinvented and rechristened it the Shankar veena. It almost sings in her hands. On June 12 at The Habitat Centre, Delhi.